



Is it dead or alive?

Not all plants store enough water to get through the dry season. Dried resurrection plants curl into a ball, pull up their roots from the ground, and get blown by the wind to a place where they may find water and come back to life.

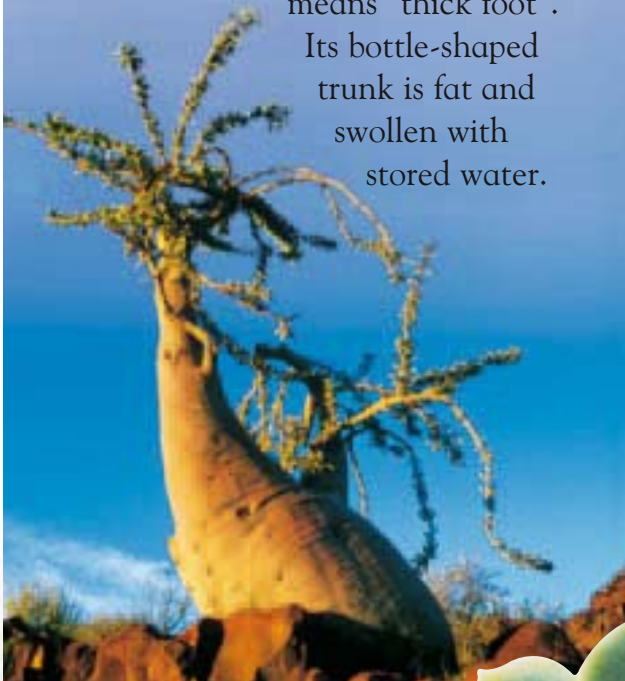
A flash of colour

Deserts are not always dry. There is a short spring season that brings heavy rains. Plants that live here are ready to germinate and flower very quickly – the season lasts just three weeks.

Bottled water

This funny-looking tree is called a pachypodium, which means “thick foot”.

Its bottle-shaped trunk is fat and swollen with stored water.



Keep your hair on

The hairy white spines of these cacti reflect the strong heat of the desert sun. This built-in sunscreen stops the plant drying out.

It's full of water

Juicy, fleshy, waxy leaves are the sign of most succulents. This is where the plant stores its water. The waxy coating stops water evaporating from the leaves.

